PROJECT WORTH

WISCONSIN CHILD PROTECTION SYSTEM GAPS

WISCONSIN HAS TAKEN IMPORTANT STEPS. SERIOUS GAPS REMAIN.

Wisconsin first strengthened protections against grooming in schools and has since expanded those protections to other settings.

But grooming laws alone cannot protect children when reports remain disconnected, patterns are not tracked, and survivors have no clear pathway forward.

THE CENTRAL QUESTION

Why does Wisconsin place so much responsibility on those with the least power?

Children should not be expected to recognize grooming before trained adults do.

Survivors should not lose access to protection because disclosure took time.

Families should not have to navigate disconnected agencies and reporting systems on their own.

WISCONSIN'S RED LIGHT GAPS

- NO UNIVERSAL MANDATED REPORTING REQUIREMENT
- NO CENTRALIZED STATEWIDE REPORTING SYSTEM
- LIMITED CROSS COUNTY PATTERN TRACKING
- NO PATHWAY WITHIN WISCONSIN'S CHILD PROTECTION SYSTEM FOR ADULT SURVIVORS WHEN THE PERSON RESPONSIBLE MAY STILL HAVE ACCESS TO CHILDREN
- LIMITED ACCOUNTABILITY WHEN REQUIRED REPORTS ARE NOT MADE

THESE ARE NOT UNUSUAL REQUESTS

Many states have had stronger reporting, tracking, training, and accountability measures in place for years.

Wisconsin can learn from those models and build a more survivor centered system.

THE CASE FOR CHANGE

For too long, Wisconsin laws and systems have protected institutions and those responsible for harm more than the survivors whose voices and power were taken from them.

Wisconsin now has the opportunity to change that.

Give survivors their voices back. Place responsibility on the adults and systems with the power to protect.

Build a system worthy of the trust of children, families, and survivors.

WHY IT MATTERS FOR WISCONSIN

PROTECT CHILDREN
Connect reports and patterns before more children are harmed.

SUPPORT SURVIVORS
Clear pathways restore trust without causing further harm.

STRENGTHEN COMMUNITIES
Strong systems create safer schools, families, and communities.

LEAD WISCONSIN
Wisconsin should lead with stronger protections, not play catch up with other states.

LEGISLATORS CAN CHANGE LIVES

Close the gaps. Strengthen Wisconsin's systems. Protect children. Support survivors.

WISCONSIN CAN LEAD.

PROJECT WORTH Protecting Children. Empowering Survivors. Strengthening Systems. | projectworthwi.org | info@projectworthwi.org